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SAP Labs India is the local arm of the German software major SAP



PHOTO BY SELVA PRAKASH LAKSHMANAN

“Don’t be afraid to want more for yourself”

What was the problem you were grappling with?

I moved to Germany early in my career to work at the SAP headquarters in Waldorf. Germany is like a second home to me, as both my daughters—Alisha and Rhea—were born there, and we spent considerable time there together as a family. I was offered a career-defining leadership role at the SAP headquarters while on maternity leave. As a new mother, I had apprehensions about taking on this new role that required more time at work.

Whom did you approach for advice and why?

Acknowledging my uncertainty, the leadership at SAP reassured me that they believed in me and would help me navigate the path. During this pivotal moment, my husband, Brian, played a crucial role. He switched from a full-time to a part-time work contract. This allowed me to pursue the leadership role.

What was the advice you received?

I was asked to evaluate my abilities without self-doubt. I remember being told, “If you’re ready for this role, we will handle the rest. You can get your kid to the workplace.” So, there were times when Alisha and Rhea accompanied me to work meetings. Also,

when you see your managers/leaders reiterating their confidence in you, it propels you to greater heights.

How effective was it in resolving the problem?

I accepted that crucial role and, from there, took on many more leadership roles to lead the same lab where I started my career as a young developer. Life comes full circle, and I am glad for all the opportunities that have paved my journey. There is nothing wrong with being ambitious. Don’t be afraid to want more for yourself than you ever thought you could achieve, because, in life, you don’t get what you deserve; you get what you negotiate for. **BT**

—TEAM BT

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